

CONTINGENCY PLAN

RISK MANAGEMENT PLAN # 1

Revision 1 Date: 11/01/2025

System/Asset Name: Gmail

Risk Description and Consequences:

Threats:

- Unauthorized access through phishing, weak password reuse, or credential compromise
- Accidental data deletion or corruption of important messages
- Gmail service outage or account lockout

Description: Gmail is a critical communication and authentication hub used for personal, academic, and professional correspondence. A compromise or outage could result in the exposure of sensitive information, delayed project communications, or loss of access to accounts linked through Gmail (banking, cloud services, coursework platforms, etc.).

Consequences:

- Exposure of sensitive personal or institutional data.
- Inability to verify identity for linked accounts or services.
- Reputational damage and operational delays in academic or professional tasks.
- Potential identity theft or credential misuse.

Mitigation Strategies: What is being done to minimize the probability or consequence of the risk

- Strong password enforcement using a complex, unique passphrase stored in a password manager.
- Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) enabled for all Gmail logins and enable password breach alerts.
- Periodic review of account activity and connected applications.
- Regular backups of important messages and attachments to a secure, encrypted cloud folder.
- Conduct periodic phishing simulations and verify sender authenticity.
- Use of Google's Advanced Protection Program and security alerts.

Contingency Actions and Trip Wires:

Trip Wires/Indicators that the risk is happening

- Receipt of unfamiliar sign-in alerts from unknown locations or devices.
- Missing or corrupted emails.
- Gmail login failure despite correct credentials.
- Extended Gmail service outage reported by Google Workspace Status.

Actions to take upon identification that the risk is happening

- Immediately change Gmail password and revoke all active sessions.
- Run a malware scan on connected devices to remove potential keyloggers.
- Check "Security Activity" in Google Account to identify unauthorized access.

- Use backup recovery codes or trusted device login to restore access.
- Contact Google Support to validate identity and recover the account if locked.
- Restore critical messages from offline or cloud backups if data loss occurs.

Resources needed:

Training: Periodic refresher on phishing awareness and secure email handling.

Backups:

- Encrypted offline backups using Outlook or Thunderbird.
- Cloud-based archive in Google Takeout.

Software/Hardware:

- Password manager (e.g., Bitwarden, 1Password).
- Antivirus and endpoint protection tools.
- Secure laptop and mobile device with up-to-date patches.
- Secondary email for recovery and 2FA verification device.

Notifications

- Google Account Recovery / Gmail Support.
- University IT Help Desk (if academic account linked).
- Supervisor / Professor (if coursework deadlines or data affected).
- Financial institutions or service providers (if account credentials reused elsewhere).

Subject Matter Expert/Person Responsible for implementing plan

Person Responsible: Tiwa Shadare (Myself)

Subject Matter Expert: Tiwa Shadare, Cyber Security Enthusiast

Date Plan Must be Ready

Due Date: December 1, 2025

Approvals

- **Course Instructor:** Prof. Murray
- **Owner / User:** Tiwa Shadare

RISK MANAGEMENT PLAN # 2

Revision 1 Date:11/01/2025

System/Asset Name: External Hard Drive

Risk Description and Consequences:

Threats:

- Physical loss, theft, or damage to the external drive
- Data corruption or malware infection from unsafe backups
- Power surges or hardware failure leading to data inaccessibility

Description: The external hard drive is a key hardware asset used to store personal, academic, and professional files, including backups of sensitive information. It serves as both a primary backup and offline data repository. A failure, loss, or compromise of this device could lead to permanent data loss, exposure of confidential material, or operational downtime if critical files become unavailable.

Consequences:

- Permanent loss or exposure of sensitive personal and professional data
- Disruption of project continuity and coursework submissions
- Potential reputational or financial loss from data breach
- Recovery costs associated with drive repair or forensic data retrieval

Mitigation Strategies:

What is being done to minimize the probability or consequence of the risk

- Full-disk encryption (BitLocker or VeraCrypt) enabled to prevent unauthorized data access if the drive is lost or stolen
- Regular backups following the 3-2-1 principle: three copies of data, on two types of media, with one stored offsite or in the cloud
- Antivirus scanning performed before each data transfer or synchronization
- SMART monitoring enabled to detect early signs of mechanical failure
- Physical protection measures: drive stored in a secure, climate-controlled area when not in use
- Use of certified data wiping tools or physical destruction before disposal
- Scan drives before backup and isolate infected media

Contingency Actions and Trip Wires:

Trip Wires/Indicators that the risk is happening

- Clicking or beeping noises from the drive (mechanical failure indicators)
- System not recognizing the device upon connection
- Slow data transfer speeds or frequent error messages during file copy
- Recent physical mishandling, power surge, or liquid exposure
- Detection of malware or unusual file modifications

Actions to take upon identification that the risk is happening

- Immediately disconnect the hard drive from the system to prevent further damage or data corruption.
- Attempt data access using a verified secondary system or data recovery software (read-only mode).
- Run diagnostics via manufacturer tools (e.g., WD Dashboard, Seagate Toolkit) to confirm health status.
- Restore files from alternate cloud or secondary physical backups.
- If drive is physically damaged, contact a certified data recovery service (e.g., Ontrack or DriveSavers).
- Replace the faulty drive and recreate backup routines on the new hardware.

Resources needed:

Training: Proper handling and data backup procedures; awareness of physical and cyber risks to external storage

Backups: Redundant copies stored in encrypted cloud and on secondary drives

Software/Hardware:

- Encryption software (BitLocker, VeraCrypt)
- Antivirus tools for scanning external storage
- SMART monitoring utilities for hardware health tracking
- UPS (Uninterruptible Power Supply) and surge protector
- Replacement external drive for redundancy

Notifications

- Data Recovery Service Provider (e.g., Ontrack, DriveSavers)
- IT Support or Systems Administrator
- Cloud backup provider (if restoration required)
- Professor or Supervisor (if data pertains to coursework or projects)
- Warranty or manufacturer support (for replacement authorization)

Subject Matter Expert/Person Responsible for implementing plan

Person Responsible: Tiwa Shadare (Myself)

Subject Matter Expert: Tiwa Shadare, Cyber Security Enthusiast

Date Plan Must be Ready

Due Date: December 1, 2025

Approvals

- **Course Instructor:** Prof. Murray
- **Owner / User:** Tiwa Shadare

Contingency Plan Matrix

Asset Name	Threat	Consequences	Risk Description	Mitigation Strategy	Contingency Actions	Date Plan Ready	Resources Needed	Priority
Gmail	Unauthorized access or phishing	Data exposure, loss of access	Contains sensitive personal, academic, and financial data; breach may cause identity theft or service disruption.	Enable 2FA, use strong passwords, monitor account activity, and back up important emails.	Reset password, revoke sessions, use recovery codes, notify contacts, restore from backup	12/01/2025	Password manager, antivirus, recovery codes, 2FA device, cloud backup.	High
External Hard Drive	Loss, theft, or hardware failure	Data loss, exposure of files	Stores critical personal and academic backups; damage or theft could cause data loss or privacy breach.	Encrypt drive, perform 3-2-1 backups, scan for malware, and store securely.	Disconnect faulty drive, attempt recovery, restore from cloud/offsite backup, replace drive.	12/01/2025	Encryption tool, backup drive, UPS, antivirus, secure storage.	High